

and worms spread via e-mail by enticing users to open attachments. If you get e-mail with attachments, open it only if you were expecting it. Worms send themselves to addresses from an address book, so it's not safe to open attachments even if it's from someone you know. Avoid executables altogether—it's better to miss a joke than become one. Watch out for attachments that are named as filename.jpg.exe—these are executables too. Various services on the Internet alert you about new viruses and their nature as soon as they are discovered. Sign up with a good one to keep yourself updated so that you know well in advance how to avoid them.

How do I copy text and images from a PDF document?

Adobe Acrobat Reader has three tools: one for selecting text, one for selecting columns and a third for selecting graphics. Use the Text Selection tool from the toolbar to select running text, as you would in a Word document. The Column Selection tool (drop down the options under the Text Selection tool to access this) is great for picking up blocks of text, say from a brochure. Draw a rectangle around the area you want to pick out text from and only the text within that box will be selected. The Graphic Selection tool is tricky—images are not separate objects in a PDF document. Draw a rectangle



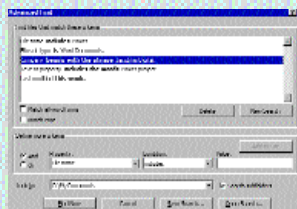
Selecting blocks of text from PDFs

around the image you want to copy. Even if that area contains text, it will be copied as a graphic element, which you can paste into any image-editing application.

There are just so many documents! I can't find the contract agreement for the Power project!

If you have a lot of unorganised documents, finding the right one can be quite time-consuming. It's always faster to have the computer look for them rather than you taking up the task. All the applications in Microsoft Office—Word, Excel, PowerPoint and Access—have extremely powerful search features that locate the required file. On the File Open dialog, you can have the program look for files that contain certain text by entering the text in the Text or Property area. You can also filter down the selection to a particular date from the Last Modified drop down list. Click Advanced and you can specify an infinite number of criteria to locate documents. The Advanced Find dialog automatically picks up criteria specified on the File Open dialog (text, document type and modified date). You can add more by selecting a property (File Name, Compa-

ny, Author, etc), selecting a comparison condition (includes or begins with), entering a value for comparison and clicking Add to List. Once you've specified all the criteria, click Find Now. The File Open dialog box will display only documents that match. If you enabled 'Search subfolders', Word will display the entire tree structure down to the documents!



Locating documents is easy in MS Office

From the Advanced Find dialog, you can also save searches for later reuse. Thus, even if your documents are organised well, but across a few folders, you can save certain commonly-used searches and simply use those to open up documents of a particular kind in a single click. The New Search button resets the search criteria.

He expects me to know the entire Internet by heart? Now where am I going to find Web sites on corporate successes?

The World Wide Web is a huge resource of information, but research is akin to filling a glass from a gushing fire hydrant. However, search engines are getting better by the day and within minutes you can open up a whole

bunch of Web sites that are relevant to your topic. Search engines have grown smarter and know how to avoid cheap tactics of Web developers to get their pages to show up on search results. Also, some of them actually have hand-picked selections of Web sites. Most already use referral ratings to prioritise search results—if the site is linked from a reputed site, it gets a higher priority. Thus, you can simply enter the words you are looking for and find relevant results within the first 20 matches.

Google (www.google.com) is known to give the most accurate search results for the simplest of queries. However, almost all search engines have a lot of mechanisms for advanced searching, which are usually unknown to most. Again, the way to use advanced searches differs from engine to engine. For example, wrapping text in double-quotes indicates a phrase search. And, Or, - and + usually indicate boolean searches, depending on the search engine. Sites like



Cool search options at HotBot